ly / ly and lololololo

Current fonts, native kerning, equal x-height.

Regular upright

Lato26

lololololo

ly ly

Mid-height lo / ol / lo / ol: 23.3 / 22.9 / 25.2 / 23.4

Interaction ly/ly 1.11; lo/lo 1.41; ol/ol 1.07

Fira Sans

lololololo

ly ly

Mid-height lo / ol / lo / ol: 29.8 / 27.1 / 31.9 / 29.8

Interaction ly/ly 0.85; lo/lo 1.26; ol/ol 1.80

Bold upright

Lato26

lololololo

ly ly

Mid-height lo / ol / lo / ol: 19.3 / 18.8 / 22.9 / 19.2

Interaction ly/ly 0.87; lo/lo 1.06; ol/ol 1.05

Fira Sans

lololololo

ly ly

Mid-height lo / ol / lo / ol: 18.1 / 16.2 / 21.7 / 18.3

Interaction ly/ly 0.74; lo/lo 0.90; ol/ol 1.38

Regular italic

Lato26

lololololo

ly ly

Mid-height lo / ol / lo / ol: 24.7 / 22.1 / 25.0 / 24.8

Interaction ly/ly 1.48; lo/lo 1.55; ol/ol 1.62

Fira Sans

lololololo

ly ly

Mid-height lo / ol / lo / ol: 29.4 / 27.7 / 30.1 / 29.5

Interaction ly/ly 1.12; lo/lo 1.28; ol/ol 1.46

Bold italic

Lato26

lololololo

ly ly

Mid-height lo / ol / lo / ol: 20.8 / 18.2 / 22.8 / 20.8

Interaction ly/ly 1.28; lo/lo 1.15; ol/ol 1.54

Fira Sans

lololololo

ly ly

Mid-height lo / ol / lo / ol: 18.1 / 16.5 / 19.7 / 18.1

Interaction ly/ly 1.00; lo/lo 1.09; ol/ol 1.26

Gaps: sampled halfway up x-height, as % of x-height. The four-gap cycle repeats.

Interaction: 1 means equal blurred-ink overlap; below 1 means weaker interaction.

Three blur radii: 6%, 12%, 24% of x-height. This is a diagnostic, not a target.

Data: build/proofs/fira-rhythm-comparison.json. References: Fira Sans 4.301.

Preserved rhythm after the e edit

Previous and current Lato26 at equal x-height; l outlines, advances and kerning unchanged.

Regular upright

Before

Body gap lo/lo 1.09; interaction lo/lo 1.41

Interaction ly/ly 1.11

After

Body gap lo/lo 1.09; interaction lo/lo 1.41

Interaction ly/ly 1.11

Bold upright

Before

Body gap lo/lo 1.19; interaction lo/lo 1.06

Interaction ly/ly 0.87

After

Body gap lo/lo 1.19; interaction lo/lo 1.06

Interaction ly/ly 0.87

Regular italic

Before

Body gap lo/lo 1.01; interaction lo/lo 1.55

Interaction ly/ly 1.48

After

Body gap lo/lo 1.01; interaction lo/lo 1.55

Interaction ly/ly 1.48

Bold italic

Before

Body gap lo/lo 1.09; interaction lo/lo 1.15

Interaction ly/ly 1.28

After

Body gap lo/lo 1.09; interaction lo/lo 1.15

Interaction ly/ly 1.28

Special pairs keep their edge clearances; ordinary pairs follow the narrower l advance.

Accented forms follow their bases; individual hook and mark clearance exceptions remain.

These measurements guide the design; they are not validated perceptual targets.

lj / lj and vertical-stem rhythm

Current fonts at equal x-height. lj, li and lh use the narrower l; capital-I pairs stay fixed.

Regular upright

Lato26

Stem gaps lj / lj: 35.9 / 31.5% x-height

Stem gaps li / li: 35.9 / 31.5% x-height

Interaction lj/lj 3.74; li/li 3.38; lh/lh 3.06

Fira Sans

Stem gaps lj / lj: 39.7 / 36.6% x-height

Stem gaps li / li: 39.5 / 36.4% x-height

Interaction lj/lj 4.25; li/li 3.70; lh/lh 3.63

Bold upright

Lato26

Stem gaps lj / lj: 31.1 / 27.1% x-height

Stem gaps li / li: 31.1 / 27.1% x-height

Interaction lj/lj 2.92; li/li 2.68; lh/lh 2.45

Fira Sans

Stem gaps lj / lj: 28.1 / 23.5% x-height

Stem gaps li / li: 28.1 / 23.5% x-height

Interaction lj/lj 1.65; li/li 1.46; lh/lh 1.43

Regular italic

Lato26

Stem gaps lj / lj: 34.9 / 31.1% x-height

Stem gaps li / li: 35.0 / 31.1% x-height

Interaction lj/lj 3.01; li/li 2.62; lh/lh 2.42

Fira Sans

Stem gaps lj / lj: 38.2 / 36.6% x-height

Stem gaps li / li: 38.2 / 36.6% x-height

Interaction lj/lj 5.03; li/li 4.16; lh/lh 4.13

Bold italic

Lato26

Stem gaps lj / lj: 30.7 / 26.8% x-height

Stem gaps li / li: 30.7 / 26.8% x-height

Interaction lj/lj 2.23; li/li 1.99; lh/lh 1.89

Fira Sans

Stem gaps lj / lj: 26.0 / 23.6% x-height

Stem gaps li / li: 26.2 / 23.7% x-height

Interaction lj/lj 2.08; li/li 1.83; lh/lh 1.81

lj follows li: their upright stem gaps and lower-bowl clearances are identical in Lato26.

Italic stem gaps are also almost identical. The j descender makes bounding-box gaps misleading.

Default l spacing changes together across vertical stems; no separate lj correction is applied.

Stem gaps are sampled at half x-height. Interaction uses the three-scale ink diagnostic.